Can you actually make money building apps online?

What the verified revenue of 1,000 internet startups tells us.

What is TrustMRR, and why trust these numbers?

A public registry of verified startup revenue

TrustMRR is a website where founders list their startup and connect the payment system that actually collects their money — Stripe, RevenueCat and others. The revenue figures are read straight from those accounts. Nobody can type in a flattering number; the payment processor is the source.

Why that matters

Social media is full of income claims that can't be checked. This dataset - 1,000 startups, frozen on 30 July 2026 — is the rare place where every figure has a receipt behind it.

What this presentation sets out to do: use those thousand verified records to separate the myth of online business from its reality — how much the typical startup really earns, who the winners are, and which choices measurably improve the odds.

Dataset: 1,000 startups from trustmrr.com; each row includes verified monthly revenue, category, audience, country and sale status.

Finding 1

Out of every 10 startups, only 2 are real businesses

4 earn under $100 a month

4 earn a side income

2 earn $5,000+

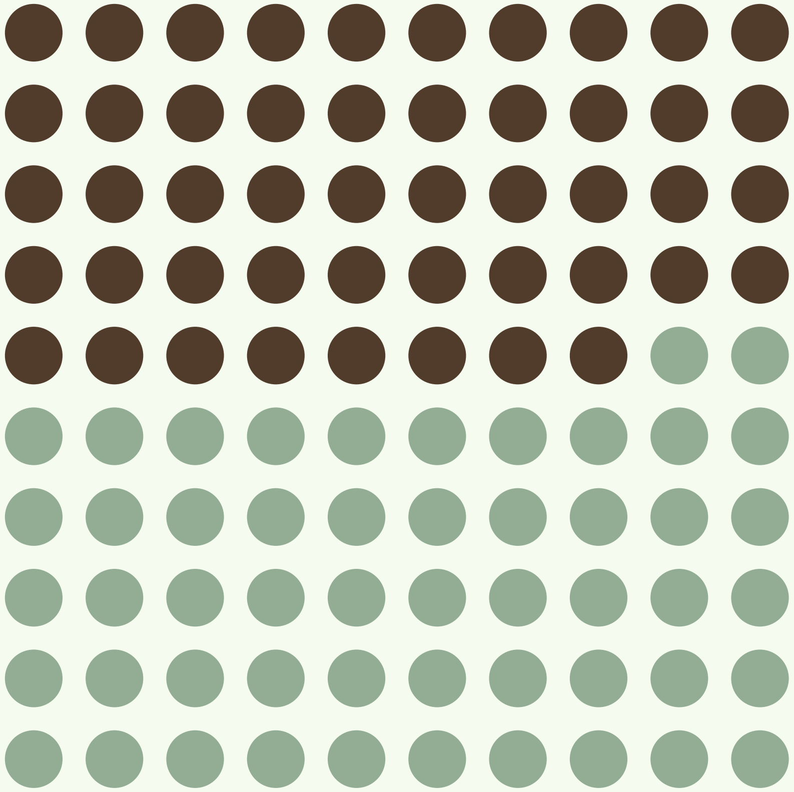
The startup in the middle earns **$282 a month** – about ₹24,000. Half of the thousand earn less than that.

197 of them earn nothing at all.

Sorted by monthly revenue: 394 under $100 (197 at $0), 354 between $100–$5K, 252 above $5K. Median = $282.

Finding 2

Ten startups take home half the money



Each circle is 1% of everything these 1,000 startups earn in a month.

The dark share belongs to just ten companies.

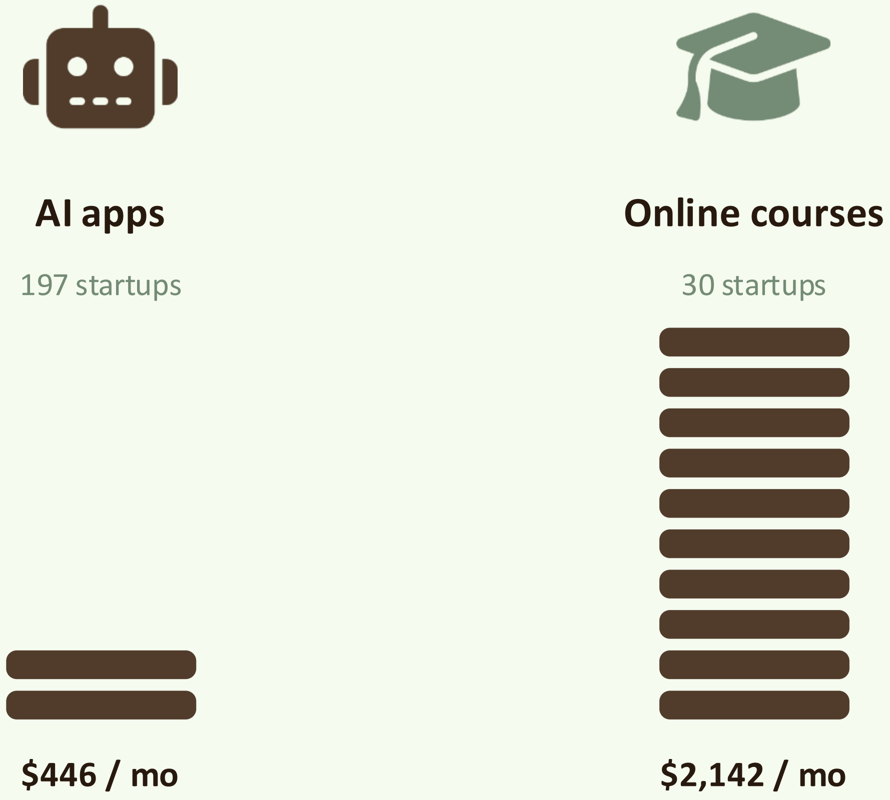
The largest of them, Stan, earns $3.57 million a month - more than the bottom nine hundred combined.

Online business follows the same curve as film or music: a few stars, a very long tail.

Total monthly revenue $13.47M; ten largest sum to $6.46M (48.0%). Stan $3.57M vs bottom 900 combined $2.45M.

Finding 3

AI is the most crowded category. Education pays five times better.



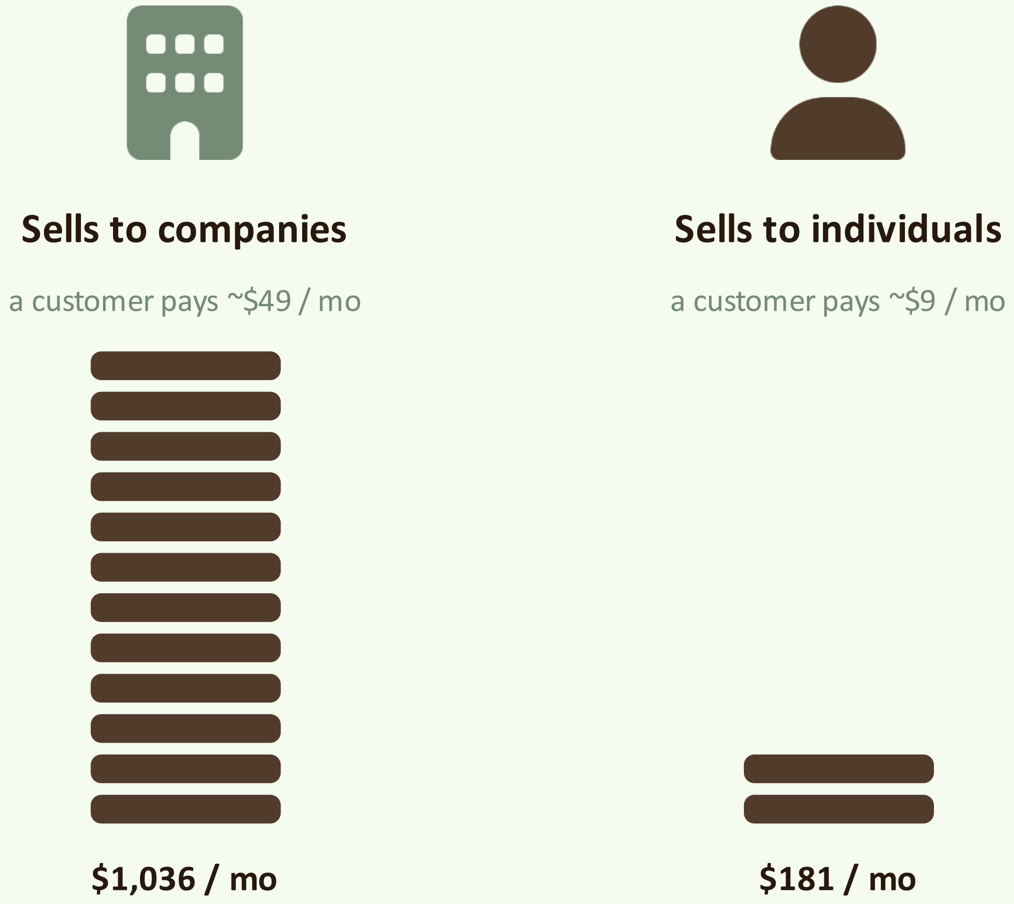
One in five founders here built an AI product. The crowd split the customers, and the typical AI app now earns less than a fifth of what a typical course business makes.

Marketing, analytics and content tools sit in between - all of them ahead of AI.

Median monthly revenue by category: Education $2,142 (30) · Marketing $1,586 (42) · Analytics $1,294 (19) · AI $446 (197). Coin = ~$220.

Finding 4

Selling to companies pays six times more than selling to people



A company pays from its office budget and stays for years. A person pays from their own pocket and cancels when the month gets tight.

Same effort to build. Very different customer.

255 startups sell to companies (median $1,036/mo, $49 per customer); 401 sell to individuals (median $181/mo, $9.34 per customer).

A big social following doesn't mean a big income

The biggest audience in the dataset - 365,992 followers - belongs to a company earning **$0 a month.**

Meanwhile, the startups with no social presence at all - private companies that never posted - typically earn **$2,199 a month**, more than every follower group except the very largest.

Across all thousand startups, followers and revenue barely move together. Paying customers are the only audience that counts.

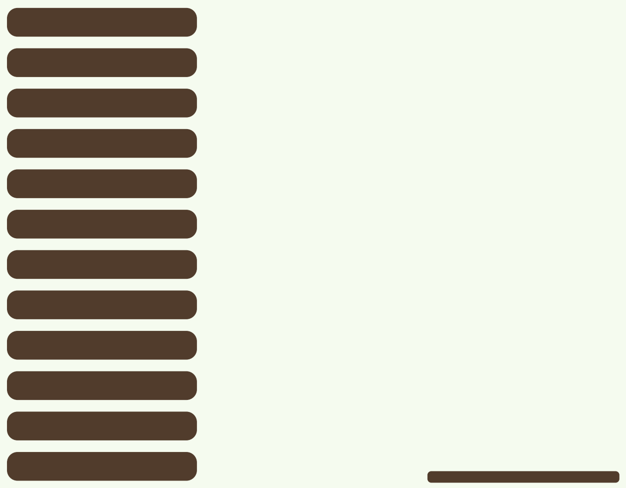
Correlation between followers and revenue: 0.17 (vs 0.90 for paying subscriptions). Zero-follower group median $2,199/mo across ~197 startups.

Finding 6

Indian founders start many and earn little — unless they price for the world

Typical monthly income, by country

India places third in the world by number of startups here — 59 of them. The typical one earns six dollars a month.



USA · $1,263

India · $6

The three Indian startups that broke through:

Supergrow $79,479 / mo

Web3Forms $33,002 / mo

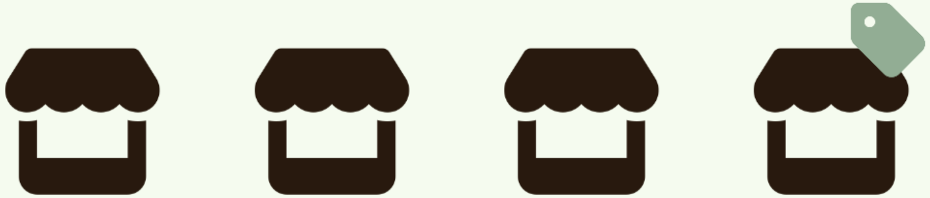
MagicSlides $13,499 / mo

All three sell worldwide and charge in dollars. They priced for New York, not for the local market - and that one decision separates them from the other fifty-six.

Median monthly revenue among startups listing a country: USA $1,262.50 (258) · India $5.97 (59). India top-3 verified to the dollar.

Finding 7

A quarter of these businesses are for sale — most for less than a car



262 of the 1,000, carry a for-sale sign, asking $86.8 million between them.

The market has settled on a price: **about two years of revenue.** Eighty-two of the listings ask under $10,000 - small businesses that pay their owner every month.

And the sellers aren't giving up on failures.

The typical listed startup earns $1,055 a month - five times more than the typical unlisted one. People sell things that are worth something; dead projects just get abandoned quietly.

For a buyer, that means real, income-producing internet businesses now change hands at prices an individual can afford.

262 listed; combined asking $86.8M; median price $35,000; median price-to-annual-revenue 2.3; 82 under $10K; median revenue $1,055 (listed) vs $187 (unlisted).

What the numbers say

Sell to companies, not individuals.

Pick the quiet niche over the crowded trend.

Count paying customers, not followers.

Price for the world, in dollars.

The typical startup here earns $282 a month. Each of these four choices measurably moves that number — the difference between a hobby and a living isn't luck, it's positioning.